

Academic Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students begin by examining various aspects of Canada's population. The initial inquiry explores population distribution, density, migration, and immigration patterns and explores urban versus rural areas. Following the initial exploration students are to access the data available on the Statistics Canada web site. From this site a vast variety of data can be accessed. These data are to be used to formulate a geographical inquiry into Canada's demographics. Students are asked to produce a newspaper article to explain one of the patterns they encountered during their inquiry. The article should attempt to explain and predict the changing nature of Canada's demographics. The report should conclude by suggesting ways to prepare for the future. Students are instructed to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams, or pictures, in the article.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from three strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Understanding and Managing Change; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. identify and analyse patterns of spatial organization, including land use, population distribution, and ecozones;
2. identify patterns of migration within Canada, and between Canada and other countries;
3. analyse statistical data on population density to identify trends and variations;
4. identify and explain the regional distribution patterns of various peoples across Canada (e.g., Aboriginal peoples, francophones, immigrant groups);
5. demonstrate an understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada;
6. demonstrate an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data;
7. locate and use effectively geographic material from primary sources (e.g., field research, surveys, interviews) and secondary sources (e.g., mainstream and alternative media, CD-ROMs, Internet) to research a geographic issue;
8. select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data;
9. create and use effectively photographs, charts, graphs, models, and diagrams;
10. use geographic data to support conclusions and opinions.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- knowledge of the definition of an ecozone
- knowledge of some of Canada's ecozones and their physical characteristics (e.g. landforms, climate, vegetation, and soils)
- interpret and use population pyramids
- identify the causes of immigration and emigration
- understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials
- ability to read, analyse, and interpret graphs and maps
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research

Task Rubric – Canada’s Population Trends Newspaper Article

Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50 – 59)	Level 2 (60 –69)	Level 3 (70 – 79)	Level 4 (80-100)
<u>Knowledge / understanding</u>					
5,6	- Demonstrate an understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada - Demonstrate an understanding of the method used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data	- Demonstrates little understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada - Demonstrates little understanding of the methods used with geographic data	- Demonstrates some understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada - Demonstrates some understanding of the methods used with geographic data	- Demonstrates considerable understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada - Demonstrates considerable understanding of the methods used with geographic data	- Demonstrates a high degree of understanding of the factors influencing demographics and migration in Canada - Demonstrates a high degree of understanding of the methods used with geographic data
<u>Thinking / Inquiry</u>					
1,2,3,10	- Identify and analyse patterns of population distribution and migration - Analyse statistical data on population density to identify trends and variations - Use geographic data to support conclusions and opinions	- Shows little analyses of population distribution and migration patterns - Shows little analyses on population density to identify trends and variations - Few uses of geographic data to support conclusions and opinions	- Shows some analyses of population distribution and migration patterns - Shows some analyses on population density to identify trends and variations - Some uses of geographic data to support conclusions and opinions	- Shows considerable analyses of population distribution and migration patterns - Shows considerable analyses on population density to identify trends and variations - Considerable uses of geographic data to support conclusions and opinions	- Shows a high degree of analyses of population distribution and migration patterns - Shows a high degree of analyses on population density to identify trends and variations - Uses geographic data to support conclusions and opinions at a higher degree of inquiry
<u>Communication</u>					
8,9	- Select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data - Create and use effectively photographs, charts and graphs	- Uses few methods for displaying geographic data - Uses few visuals	- Uses some methods for displaying geographic data - Uses some visuals	- Uses many methods for displaying geographic data - Uses many visuals	- Uses many appropriate methods for displaying geographic data - Uses many visuals with purpose
<u>Application</u>					
4	Identify and explain the regional distribution patterns of various peoples across Canada	Identifies and explains little regional distribution patterns	Identifies and explains some regional distribution patterns	Identifies and explains effectively regional distribution patterns	Identifies and explains at a high degree regional distribution patterns